

BEYOND THE KINGDOM — Supporting Cast

Document 07 · Locked Canon · The World Around the Kingdom

All ages exact as of Monday, January 3, 2005. Unless noted, every character is African American. Non-Black characters are marked †. They're the few the premise calls for.

THE DONOHUE ORBIT

Constance "Connie" Pryor Donohue — *The Trophy With Teeth*

- **Born:** August 14, 1966 · **Age:** 38 · **Looks:** late 20s
- Theodore's third wife, married 1998. She was a Delta flight attendant who met Theodore in first class.
- The family calls her a gold digger. She calls herself "a diversified portfolio."
- **SECRET:** She secretly writes "**CrestWatch**," the anonymous gossip blog that has leaked Belmont Crest secrets since 2003. The whole city reads it, and nobody suspects the woman who always seems bored at dinner.
- **Voice:** *"Honey, I didn't marry for money. I married for access. Money was just parked outside."*

Reginald Donohue — *The Forgotten Son*

- **Born:** September 9, 1957 · **Age:** 47 · **Looks:** late 30s
- Theodore's only son, from his first marriage. He was a Georgia State Senator until he resigned in 1999 over a land-deal scandal. Theodore made that scandal go away quietly.
- Now **President of Donohue Realty**. Victor gave him the job as a peace offering, and Reginald treats it like an insult.
- Divorced, bitter, and drinking. He knows where some of his father's vault files are buried.
- **Voice:** *"My father was passed over. I was passed under."*

Winston Fairley — *The Butler*

- **Born:** October 10, 1942, Kingston, Jamaica · **Age:** 62 · **Looks:** late 40s
- **Head of Household, Donohue Manor, since 1968.** He was trained at London's Savoy.
- He knows every secret in the Manor and will die before repeating one. Marc was the one who organized the staff's 1994 pay strike, and Winston has been his quiet ally ever since.
- **Voice:** *"Sir, I don't listen at doors. Doors simply speak to me."*

Ruby Mae Tolliver — *"Nana Ruby"*

- **Born:** December 25, 1938, Americus, Georgia · **Age:** 66 · **Looks:** mid-50s
 - **Housekeeper at Belle Rive (the Bullock estate) since 1980.** She raised Elxa, Marc, and Grace as much as Natasha did.
 - Marc loves her like a grandmother. **Anyone who hurts Nana Ruby meets the monster.**
 - She's from Americus, like Alexander. She knew the Donohue name before it was famous.
 - **Voice:** *"Baby, I changed your diapers. Don't you dare 'Miss Tolliver' me."*
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BELMONT CREST FIXTURES

Percival "Percy" Langston — The Gatekeeper

- **Born:** May 5, 1949 · **Age:** 55 · **Looks:** early 40s
- **General Manager, Belmont Crest Country Club** since 1984. He guards the club's etiquette like scripture and its waiting list like Fort Knox.
- He loves the old guard and fears new money. Esther Smalley will be his worst nightmare.
- **Voice:** *"Membership is not purchased, madam. It is bestowed."*

Bishop Everett Lyons — The Shepherd

- **Born:** April 1, 1944 · **Age:** 60 · **Looks:** late 40s
- **Senior Pastor, Greater Crest Tabernacle AME**, since 1979. A civil-rights-era preacher and the Donohues' spiritual adviser.
- He baptized Marc, married Elxa, and hears confessions he shouldn't have to keep.
- **Voice:** *"God forgives. Belmont Crest keeps minutes."*

First Lady Pearl Lyons

- **Born:** August 30, 1947 · **Age:** 57 · **Looks:** mid-40s
 - She runs the church, the Magnolia Cotillion, and every piece of gossip that goes through the choir loft.
 - **Voice:** *"I'm not gossiping. I'm putting it on the prayer list."*
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THE BAKER FAMILY (Magnolia Terrace, upper middle class)

Dr. Curtis Baker — The Dentist

- **Born:** January 19, 1954 · **Age:** 50 · **Looks:** early 40s

- Meharry Medical College DDS. Owns **Baker Family Dentistry** in Buckhead.
- A proud, decent, by-the-book man. He wants Amond to be "respectable." **He has no idea his son is the underboss of the Blackwater Syndicate.**
- **Voice:** *"Son, a man is only as good as his name, and ours is clean."*

Gloria Baker — The Principal

- **Born:** May 3, 1956 · **Age:** 48 · **Looks:** late 30s
- **Principal of Frederick Douglass High School** (Atlanta Public Schools). She's tough love incarnate. She adores Lyric and quietly resents that Harmony keeps her granddaughter at arm's length.
- **Voice:** *"I've expelled better liars than you before first period."*

Kiara Baker — The Little Sister

- **Born:** March 11, 1989 · **Age:** 15 · **Looks:** 15
- Amond's little sister and a sophomore at Belmont Crest Academy. She's a hacker in training who idolizes "Uncle" Marc and is way too curious about Amond's late nights.
- **Voice:** *"I'm not snooping. I'm doing investigative journalism."*

THE CUMMINGS FAMILY (Kingsridge, upper class)

Franklin Cummings — The Mogul

- **Born:** June 27, 1950 · **Age:** 54 · **Looks:** early 40s
- **Chairman, Cummings Media Group**, with 60 radio stations across the South. He's a Donohue Media board member and chairman of the Country Club board.
- He's grooming Arianna for Attorney General, then Governor. He'd sell his soul for her success, and he has sold a few pieces already.
- **Voice:** *"In this state, you're either on the radio or you're being talked about on it."*

Dr. Yvette Cummings — The Cardiologist

- **Born:** December 9, 1953 · **Age:** 51 · **Looks:** late 30s
- **Chief of Cardiology, Atlanta Presbyterian Medical Center**, Peter Olson's colleague.
- She senses her daughter changed after New Year's 2002 and has never been able to find out why.
- **Voice:** *"I fix hearts for a living, Arianna. I know when one is breaking."*

THE DIVINE FAMILY (Cascade Heights, middle class)

Calvin Divine — The Father

- **Born:** February 28, 1953 · **Age:** 51 · **Looks:** early 40s
- **MARTA bus operator for 28 years** (Route 71, Cascade Road). He's a deacon, a union man, and a gentle giant broken by his son's disappearance.
- **Voice:** *"I drive the same route every day in case my boy's at one of the stops."*

Loretta Divine — The Mother

- **Born:** September 12, 1955 · **Age:** 49 · **Looks:** late 30s
- **ER Charge Nurse, Grady Memorial Hospital.** She's fierce and funny, and she's decided she no longer believes in the police.
- **Voice:** *"I've patched up half this city. The other half owes me."*

Darnell "Dee" Divine — The Missing Son

- **Born:** July 7, 1979 · **Last seen:** New Year's Eve 2001, age 22 · **Would be 25 today**
 - A barber and aspiring music producer who was the light of the family. He was walking home from a party off Northside Drive and never arrived.
 - **SECRET:** He was killed by Arianna Cummings' car at about 2:40 AM on January 1, 2002. **Marc-Anthony made his body disappear.**
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THE JACKSON FAMILY

Former Chief Harold Jackson — The Old Lion

- **Born:** April 4, 1947 · **Age:** 57 · **Looks:** late 40s
- **Chief of Police, APD (1998–2004).** He retired in December 2004 and was succeeded by his daughter-in-law.
- Old-school and proud. He has quiet doubts about how Elxa was appointed, and has quiet guilt about a case he buried in 2000: **the Harlow file.**
- **Voice:** *"I carried a badge 35 years. I know what a favor smells like."*

Denise Jackson — The Mother-in-Law

- **Born:** July 22, 1950 · **Age:** 54 · **Looks:** early 40s
- A retired schoolteacher. She thinks Elxa is too ambitious and the Donohues are too everything.
- **Voice:** *"I didn't raise my son to be the Chief's husband."*

LAW, ORDER & POLITICS

Mayor Josephine "Jo" Whitaker

- **Born:** October 1, 1949 · **Age:** 55 · **Looks:** mid-40s
- **Mayor of Atlanta** in the show's universe. (Soap convention: the show uses fictional officeholders.)
- Brilliant, pragmatic, and compromised. She appointed Elxa after "conversations" with Victor Donohue and Robert Bullock.
- **Voice:** *"I serve the people of Atlanta. The Donohues just happen to be a lot of people."*

Deputy Chief Warren Hughes — The Passed-Over Cop

- **Born:** October 19, 1958 · **Age:** 46 · **Looks:** late 30s
- A 25-year APD veteran and Harold Jackson's protégé. He expected to be Chief, and he wants Elxa to fail.
- **Voice:** *"I've got shoes older than the Chief."*

† Special Agent Kathleen "Kate" Doyle — The Fed

- **Born:** March 8, 1970, South Boston · **Age:** 34 · Irish American
- **FBI Atlanta Field Office, Organized Crime Squad. Lead agent on "Operation Deep Water."**
- A relentless, divorced workaholic. She thinks the Blackwater Syndicate is hiding behind someone rich, and she's right.
- **Voice:** *"Every king thinks the moat's deep enough."*

† Special Agent Daniel "Danny" Reyes — The Partner

- **Born:** June 14, 1975, the Bronx · **Age:** 29 · Puerto Rican
- Doyle's partner. He's charming, a former accountant, and he follows the money. He's also a secret admirer of Sovereign's charity work.
- **Voice:** *"This guy pays hospital bills. I'm supposed to arrest Robin Hood?"*

Gordon Ellis — The Chief of Staff

- **Born:** February 14, 1968 · **Age:** 36 · **Looks:** late 20s
- **Chief of Staff to Congresswoman Jasmine Olson** since 1996. He's a political operative who knows where Jasmine's votes and bodies are buried.
- **Voice:** *"Congresswoman, the truth tested poorly."*

Lawrence Tate — The Fallen DA

- **Born:** July 19, 1951 · **Age:** 53
- The former **Fulton County DA** who lost to Arianna after the September 2004 bribery scandal. He's sure someone set him up, and he's right.
- **Voice:** *"Somebody built my coffin and sold me the nails."*

† Judge Harlan Whitcomb Jr. — The Independent Trustee

- **Born:** April 22, 1956 · **Age:** 48 · White
 - A retired Georgia Court of Appeals judge who holds **Seat 9 on the Crown Council**. He's the son of the attorney who secretly bought Belmont Crest's land for the Donohues. Honorable, independent, and the swing vote on any Disgrace Clause fight.
 - **Voice:** *"My father risked everything for this family. I won't let it destroy itself."*
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THE UNDERWORLD

Silas "The Undertaker" Merriweather — The Old King

- **Born:** December 14, 1947 · **Age:** 57 · **Looks:** late 40s
- Owns **Merriweather & Sons Funeral Homes** (seven locations). He's also Atlanta's old-school kingpin in gambling, loan-sharking, and numbers.
- He lost the **Summer of Silence (2004)** to Blackwater, and he's waiting for his chance.
- **Alvin Donohue owes him \$4.2 million and several favors.**
- **Voice:** *"Everybody comes to see me eventually. I just like it better when they're breathing."*

† Cyrus Knox — Martin's Shadow

- **Born:** March 2, 1968, Johannesburg · **Age:** 36 · White South African
 - A former mercenary and **Martin Olson's private operator**. He's a fixer, an assassin, and a ghost. He helped with two of Martin's three "accidents."
 - **Voice:** *"Mr. Olson doesn't pay me to ask why. He pays me not to."*
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MEDIA & SPOTLIGHT

Celeste Vaughn — The Anchor

- **Born:** December 21, 1980 · **Age:** 24 · **Looks:** early 20s

- **Weekend anchor and investigative reporter, WBKG Channel 8 Action News.** She's ambitious and gorgeous, and she's **Marc-Anthony's on-and-off girlfriend.**
- **Her secret goal:** Break the story of who Sovereign is. She doesn't realize she's sleeping with the answer.
- **Voice:** *"I don't chase stories, Marc. Stories chase me. You should know. You're running."*

Bernadette Sinclair — The Columnist

- **Born:** February 27, 1945 · **Age:** 59 · **Looks:** late 40s
- Writes "**Behind the Gates**," the society and gossip column of *The Atlanta Sentinel*, and has since 1974. Her column can make a debutante or bury a marriage.
- She's Constance Donohue's lunch partner. She suspects Connie writes CrestWatch.
- **Voice:** *"Darling, I never print rumors. I print previews."*

† Vince Maretti — The Paparazzo

- **Born:** September 3, 1968, South Philadelphia · **Age:** 36 · Italian American
- The best celebrity photographer in the South. He's staked out the Belmont Crest gate for 10 years. His dream is the first photo of Esther Smilley's twins with their "donor."
- **Voice:** *"Every gate's got a gap."*

BULLOCK & ASSOCIATES

Camille Rhodes, Esq. — The Other Woman

- **Born:** March 3, 1966 · **Age:** 38 · **Looks:** late 20s
- **Senior Partner, Bullock & Associates.** Robert's legal right hand and his mistress since 1999. She's brilliant and patient, and her patience is running out.
- **Voice:** *"I've kept your secrets six years, Robert. Don't make me keep a calendar."*

GRACE'S WORLD

Lionel "Lo" Pierce — The Manager

- **Born:** July 4, 1965 · **Age:** 39 · **Looks:** early 30s
- Grace's manager since her *Sweet Tea* days. He's a hustler with a heart, and he's in deep with record-label people who don't take no for an answer.
- **Voice:** *"Baby girl, platinum is just the beginning. Diamond is the goal."*

Derrick Vance — The Co-Star

- **Born:** January 15, 1979 · **Age:** 25 · **Looks:** early 20s
 - An R&B singer turned actor, **Grace's co-star and new boyfriend**. He's charming on camera and controlling off it.
 - **Warning sign for writers:** He's Marc-Anthony's next "monster" trigger.
 - **Voice:** *"Your brother doesn't scare me."* (He should.)
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THE SMILLEY ORBIT

Sebastian Kingsley — The Fiancé

- **Born:** April 29, 1977, London · **Age:** 27 · **Looks:** mid-20s · British-Ghanaian
- **Investment banker, Harcourt & Lowe.** He proposed to Esther on **Christmas Eve 2004** in Paris, and she said yes. It's a strategic engagement: Esther wants a respectable husband before the Atlanta move, and Sebastian wants the Smilley fortune.
- **SECRET:** He's been hired by Desmond Smilley to report on everything Esther does.
- **Voice:** *"Love is a merger, darling. I'm simply doing due diligence."*

† Beatrix "Nanny Bea" Pennington — The Nanny

- **Born:** July 9, 1961, Surrey, England · **Age:** 43 · White British
- A Norland-trained nanny who has raised Emma and Victoria since birth. She's fiercely protective and adores them.
- She has noticed that the girls' "donor" must have been extraordinary, and that Esther flinches whenever the Bullock boy is on television.
- **Voice:** *"Miss Victoria, we do not climb the curtains. We admire them."*

Thaddeus Crowe — The Smilley Shield

- **Born:** November 20, 1964 · **Age:** 40 · **Looks:** early 30s
 - **Head of Smilley family security.** He's a former U.S. Secret Service agent. BSI is his professional rival, and Blackwater is his professional obsession.
 - **Voice:** *"In my old job I took a bullet for the President. In this one I'd take it for the twins."*
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ALVIN'S SECRET FAMILY

Rochelle Banks — The Secret Keeper

- **Born:** May 21, 1972, College Park · **Age:** 32 · **Looks:** mid-20s
- A hair salon owner in College Park. She met Alvin Donohue (then 20) at a Freaknik party in April 1991 when she was 18. Their fling lasted until Thanksgiving 1991. She never told him about their son, because she "didn't want Donohue money to Donohue my baby."
- **Voice:** *"I didn't need his name. I needed his absence."*

Tremaine Banks — The Unknown Donohue

- **Born:** August 16, 1992 · **Age:** 12
 - A seventh-grader. He's brilliant, funny, and restless, and he has **the Donohue eyes**. He wants to know who his father is. **Future storyline:** Marc-Anthony meets Tremaine through his mentoring program and sees the resemblance first.
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BLACKWATER'S SEVEN — Profiles

(Structure in Document 06.)

Tobias Okafor — "The Ledger"

- **Born:** March 30, 1980, Houston · **Age:** 24 · Nigerian American
- MIT mathematics dropout. **CFO of BSI**. He can move a billion dollars through nine countries before breakfast.
- **Voice:** *"Money isn't dirty. People are dirty. Money just needs a bath."*

Keisha "Ghost" Lattimore — "The Ghost"

- **Born:** November 4, 1979, Decatur, Georgia · **Age:** 25
- A Georgia Tech dropout and self-taught hacker. **BSI Director of Cyber**. She runs the Archive, the Syndicate's files on everyone who matters.
- **Voice:** *"There's no such thing as private. There's just 'not yet.'"*

Roman Gaines — "The Hammer"

- **Born:** August 3, 1976, Fayetteville, North Carolina · **Age:** 28
- Former U.S. Army Ranger with two combat deployments. **BSI Director of Global Operations**. He's quiet, devout, and terrifying.
- **Voice:** *"I only say it once."*

Dolores "Mama Dee" Whitfield — "The Tithe"

- **Born:** January 12, 1951 · **Age:** 53 (turns 54 Wednesday, January 12, 2005)

- Owns **Dee's Kitchen**, a legendary soul food restaurant on Ralph David Abernathy Blvd in the West End. She's the Syndicate's heart and its conscience. She's the only person who has ever slapped Sovereign and lived.
- **Voice:** *"Eat first. Then we'll talk about who needs to disappear."*

Rashad "Saint" Mayfield — "The Saint"

- **Born:** September 18, 1981 · **Age:** 23
- Son of the Bullocks' longtime driver, and Marc's childhood brother. He owns the **Saint's Car Wash** chain (14 locations). He runs the streets for Blackwater, and he's a founding member.
- **Voice:** *"They call me Saint 'cause I forgive. Once."*

Lt. Gen. Walter Bassett, U.S. Army (Ret.) — BSI President

- **Born:** June 6, 1944 · **Age:** 60 · **Looks:** early 50s
- A retired three-star general, born on D-Day. **President & COO of BSI.** He's honorable, and he's **completely unaware of the Syndicate.**
- **Voice:** *"Son, in forty years I've never served a man I didn't trust. Don't make you the first."*

Brielle Sutton — The Assistant

- **Born:** April 8, 1983 · **Age:** 21
- Spelman senior and **Executive Assistant to Marc-Anthony.** She's hyper-organized and funny, and she's noticed that her boss's calendar has holes in it.
- **Voice:** *"Mr. Bullock, you have a 3 o'clock, a 3:15, and a 3:30 that doesn't exist. Should I keep pretending?"*

IN-UNIVERSE MEDIA OUTLETS (for the News & Fan layers)

Outlet	Type	Voice
<i>The Atlanta Sentinel</i>	Fictional major daily newspaper	Serious. Front page, Metro, Business. Bernadette Sinclair's "Behind the Gates."
WBKG Channel 8 Action News	Fictional Atlanta TV station	Breaking news. Celeste Vaughn.
<i>Peachtree Business Chronicle</i>	Fictional weekly business paper	DGH vs. Smiley coverage
<i>Atlanta Daily World</i>	Real historic Black newspaper	Community, legacy, church
<i>Jet</i>, <i>*Ebony</i>, <i>Essence</i>, <i>*Black Enterprise</i>	Real national Black magazines (2005)	Covers, weddings, "Black Royalty" features
<i>Forbes</i>, <i>*Fortune</i>, <i>*The Wall Street Journal</i>	Real business press	Net worths, deals
<i>Soap-style tabloids</i> (e.g., <i>Star</i>, <i>Us Weekly</i>)	Real tabloids	Esther's twins, Grace's romance, Marc's dating life

Outlet	Type	Voice
CrestWatch (Blogger)	Anonymous gossip blog, secretly written by Connie Donohue	Catty, leaked, and first with every rumor
"Find Dee" (LiveJournal)	Harmony's blog about her missing brother	Heartbreaking
BlackPlanet, MySpace, AOL message boards, LiveJournal	Fan and public reaction (2005-accurate)	The people's voice